



New traffic control

C-DAC has developed WiTraC, India's first wireless traffic control system that will run on solar power. <http://dgit.in/1593SSq>



UK to ban small mobiles

The UK government is mulling over plans to ban small form factor phones to prevent prisoners from getting them <http://dgit.in/17PIIre>

Work@Tech

THE STORIES BEHIND THEIR APPS

Sreekanth Sastry on Situational Gita (iOS/Android): The intent behind the app was simple - can we present the answers from the Bhagavad Gita in a new format that people can relate to in an obvious way, and can we match learning to day-to-day situations? Dr. Dinesh Anvekar who has devoted many years to the study of Bhagavad Gita helped us in this effort.

We wanted to be different from the rest of the "Gita" apps so we based the navigation on categories. We thought that would help users easily identify with their situations and quickly dive into sections they were interested in.

Rahul Mathur on Instant Access (WP): It took me a week to learn about the SDK, brush my C# skills and in another week the application was up in the marketplace. The feedback was incredible- I would get mail from several people every week telling me how useful it was. I found out that Microsoft employees were using that app too but the best part was noticing a random person in a restaurant using my app.

The whole 'post-publishing' scene was such an amazing inspiration for me to develop more applications. Instant Access isn't my most downloaded app and is one of the simplest apps I have ever written but definitely the one I am particularly proud of because it ended up giving me a head start that I required at that point.

Nirmitt Kavaiya on Ludo (Windows 8): I developed Ludo for Windows 8 last year after attending a coding hackathon organized by Microsoft in Pune. I was already developing Apps for Windows Phone, so I was quite familiar with the new features added to Windows 8. I learnt the new APIs, UI guidelines and completed Ludo in 20 days and got it approved from Microsoft.

Ludo is a free ad-supported app and has an average rating of 4.5 stars since its launch nine months ago. The in-app ads are only available in the U.S. and some European countries and I get a payout of ₹2,000 per month. That is a very small amount but, I'm working on some more features for the game like Board themes, 3D Dice, etc. and they will be available via In-App purchases so I'll be able to get more revenue from the game.

Raja & Shanti on Pick - The Purchase Tracker (iOS): The Idea for this app came to us when we took a trip to Europe last year during Christmas and shopped quite a bit. We started the development process by deciding on the core functionalities and use-case scenarios of the app.

We decided the app would do quick currency conversions, percentage calculations and keep a track of spending. The app would be targeting shoppers and travellers and would be optimized for single hand use (because shoppers will most likely have their shopping bags in one hand). The app would also need a simple and bright colour palette.

For version 1.x, we wanted to develop the core functionality of the App with a simple and intuitive user experience. Our intention was not to overload the user with "features", just to keep the App simple. Since launch, we've received a lot of positive feedback and we are gradually implementing new features.

something he wouldn't be able to do at a development firm.

Sreekanth stated that he wanted to stay away from working in bigger organizations as people there tended to have responsibilities but without the corresponding authority. Conversely, as an independent developer, he was glad to have the responsibility and authority to decide on a product plan. Raja and Shanti said that they too were happy as independent developers but were open to the idea of collaborating with others to work on projects.

If given the chance, Rahul said that he would love to work in a development firm as it would give him the freedom to simply focus on what he was good at and not be distracted by things like design, publishing and monetization. He

added that he would like to gain experience in a firm and then return to indie development in the future with a better skill-set.

On where they see themselves five years in the future

Sreekanth: "I see Antarjaal with a rich portfolio of apps that have a cumulative download count of at least a million."

Rahul: "Hopefully sipping coffee with Elon Musk and heading a product in the right direction!"

Nirmitt: "Working in a small start-up of my own with small team of people passionate about creating great Apps for whichever ecosystem they're targeting."

Raja and Shanti: "Sitting in front of a Mac, creating apps with the focus same as now." 



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